SUPPORT FOR STUDENTS POLICY

SCOPE

This policy applies to all Monash University coursework units and to students enrolled in coursework units. It does not apply to professional development education programs.

For the purpose of this policy, references to 'the University' includes Monash University Australia, Monash University Malaysia, Monash University Indonesia, Monash Suzhou, Monash Suzhou Research Institute, and the Monash University Prato Centre, unless indicated otherwise.

POLICY STATEMENT

This policy sets out the requirements for provision of services to support students, as prescribed in the *Higher Education Support Act 2003* section 19-43.

1. Provision of student support services

1.1 The University provides a range of student support services designed to cater to the varying needs of student cohorts, including but not limited to the following.

1.1.1 Academic services that include literacy and numeracy support are offered by Student Academic Success (all locations). Students can access these services by making appointments with an adviser, attending workshops and accessing online resources.

1.1.2 The Special Consideration Procedure sets out how the University supports students whose ability to complete an assessment (or assessments) has been impacted by difficult circumstances, through due date extensions, alternative assessment, exemption, or by deferring an assessment.

1.1.3 The Disability Support Services provides services at all locations to students with a disability, medical or mental health condition that affects their studies.Registered students are eligible for reasonable adjustments suited to their individual circumstances to support their success.

1.1.4 Mental health services and a broad range of medical and wellbeing support are provided through the University Health Services and other University-sourced providers to students at Australian locations. Students can access these services by booking an appointment (face-to-face or telehealth) or by accessing online resources. At Monash University Malaysia, counselling, health and wellness services are available by booking an appointment. At Monash University Indonesia, students can access wellbeing support via student support and services.

1.1.5 Critical incident reporting and responses are guided by the Community Safety and Security Policy, and the Safety and Security Incident Reporting Procedure. The Gender-Based Violence Prevention and Response Policy, Sexual Harm Response Procedure, Sexual Harm Response Schedule - Monash University Indonesia and Family Violence Support Procedure set out the University's approach to gender-based violence prevention and response. The Student Code of Conduct sets out expectations for student behaviour and available support where inappropriate behaviour has been experienced or witnessed.

- support in crisis and critical harm situations is provided by the Safer Community Unit at Australian locations.
- at Monash University Malaysia, incident reporting and response is through the Student Advisory and Support service.
- at Monash University Indonesia, a dedicated task force acts as the point of contact for incidents or concerns related to sexual abuse or harassment.

1.1.6 Monash Sport provides a range of wellbeing services that support students' physical and mental health through accessible sport, fitness and recreation programs, which students at Australian locations can access via membership, casual entry, or booked programs and facilities.

1.1.7 Career planning and employability support services are provided by a range of teams including Careers and Employability, The Generator, and Career Edge to students at Australian locations. Students can access these services by booking in for a one-on-one consultation, attending workshops, completing self-paced, online modules and online self-assessment tools. At Monash University Malaysia, these services are available through Career Services. At Monash University Indonesia, students can enquire about career planning via student support and services.

1.1.8 Students at Monash Suzhou can access mental health, wellbeing, counselling and career guidance services through services provided at Southeast University.

1.1.9 Peer support is available for undergraduate students at applicable locations through the Peer Mentoring Program (Australia), Peer Assisted Study Sessions (Australia), Peer Assisted Study Sessions (Malaysia) and Monash Student Communities (Australia and Indonesia).

1.1.10 The William Cooper Institute provides a comprehensive range of support services for Indigenous students at Australian locations, including individualised and targeted support.

1.2 To ensure the provision of support services is culturally appropriate, the University:

- offers a broad range of support services appropriate to the University's size and student profile, including targeted support for Indigenous students and students with disabilities;
- requires all staff in Australia to complete a mandatory Indigenous cultural foundation module and a Respect at Monash module;
- offers further training and professional development in cultural competency to all staff; and
- provides resources on inclusive teaching practices for academic staff.

1.3 At commencement, the University provides information to all students about the academic and pastoral support services available to assist them in their studies. This information is provided through email and during orientation programs and includes information about how to access services and how to report incidents and safety concerns.

1.4 This Support for Students Policy is published on the University's Policy Bank website. Students can navigate to and access information about support services digitally via the Student Services landing page.

1.5 Prior to the census date of each teaching period, the University informs students via email of the relevant actions that need to be taken prior to that census date, along with details on how the census date may impact academic and financial matters, helping students stay informed and make the best decisions for their studies.

1.5.1 Support services include information about census date and fee liability in communications with students who have requested access to the services, when it is appropriate to do so.

1.6 Academic and professional staff who interact with students will inform students of the available support services, when it is appropriate to do so.

1.6.1 Staff who receive and review students' applications for special consideration under the Special Consideration Procedure will include information about support services when communicating with students.

1.7 All University support services track periods of peak demand throughout the academic year and adjust staffing and allocation of resources accordingly and where possible.

2. Outreach and support for students

2.1 The Assessment Regime Procedure and the Marking and Feedback Procedure require that students are provided with feedback early in the teaching period to support further learning.

2.2 Following the unit final results release, students who have failed one or more units are assigned an academic progress level according to the Student Academic Progress Policy. Students are referred to a progress-assessment tool and faculties can make recommendations or set enrolment conditions for future teaching periods. Students are provided information about support services throughout this process, including when completing the progress-assessment tool, in email correspondence and during or following any academic progress hearings they may be required to attend.

2.3 Analytics are used before the census date of each teaching period to identify students who may not successfully complete a unit/s and to identify students with the greatest need of University support services. Students are contacted in a timely manner to enable them sufficient time to engage with the support services available.

2.3.1 The University proactively contacts students who have failed the first assessment task or Moodle activity in a unit, and/or have previously failed 50 per cent or more of their units, to inform them of and encourage them to access available support services before the census date of their teaching period.

3. Implementation and reporting

3.1 The Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Student Experience) (or delegate) has oversight responsibility for the overall effectiveness of services available to support students.

3.2 The Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Education) and the Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Student Experience), or nominees, will jointly review the accuracy and adequacy of this policy at the start of each calendar year for quality assurance and to ensure it remains fit for purpose.

3.3 The Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Student Experience), or nominee, will report on the implementation and operation of this policy and support services annually to Academic Board via the University Education Committee, this may include any insights from student complaints and other quality assurance processes and initiatives to identify improvements to support services and student outcomes.

3.4 The University will report to the Commonwealth Education Minister on its compliance with this policy inclusive of the information required at specified intervals in the Higher Education Support Act 2003 or as otherwise requested by the Minister.

DEFINITIONS

Course	A coherent sequence of units, usually leading to a degree or other award.
Student	A person who: a) is admitted to a course of study at the University; b) is enrolled at the University in a non-award study or one or more units of study on an assessed or non-assessed basis and without admission to a course of study; c) is pursuing a course of study or unit of study at the University through an exchange or study program or other arrangement between the University and another educational institution; d) is engaged in a student mobility program involving the University, whether or not the program is credited towards a course of study or unit of study; e) has completed a course of study but on or to whom the relevant degree or award has not been conferred or awarded; f) has deferred, or has intermitted, or has been suspended from, a course of study; g) is enrolled in a course of study or one or more units of study offered by the University through another educational institution; or h) has consented in writing to be bound as a student by the University statute and University regulations.

GOVERNANCE

Supporting procedures	Nil
Supporting schedules	Nil
Associated policies	Admission and Credit Policy Assessment and Academic Integrity Policy Community and Safety and Security Policy Enrolment and Timetable Policy Gender-Based Violence Prevention and Response Policy Student Academic Progress Policy Student Code of Conduct Student Complaints Policy
Related legislation	Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021 (Cth) Higher Education Support Act (2003) Higher Education Provider Guidelines Higher Education Support Amendment (Response to the Australian Universities Accord Interim Report) Act 2023
Category	Academic
Approval	Academic Board 12 December 2023
Endorsement	University Education Committee 7 December 2023

	Meeting 9/2023
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